

Claude Design Brief

Samuel Meredith — Web Designer

Project Overview

Build a personal brand website for **Samuel Meredith**, a freelance web designer based on the **Central Coast, NSW, Australia**. The site targets local small businesses, tradies, and personal brands. The tone is **relaxed, professional and kind** — approachable but credible. Not corporate. Not flashy.

This is an **editorial, warm-neutral personal brand site** — think high-end freelancer, not agency. The aesthetic draws from the references below and should feel magazine-quality while remaining accessible and human.

Visual References / Mood

The design should combine elements from these reference styles:

- **Celeste Whitmore** — asymmetric hero with portrait, services as horizontal rule list with + expand
 - **Astrid Vít** — editorial type mixing (uppercase + italic serif in same headline), dark section with services listed as large text rows
 - **Karina** — warm cream base, large display name as design element, scattered image layout
 - **Élevate** — dark full-bleed hero with large overlaid type, warm cream body sections
 - **Souvaena** — warm brown/terracotta accent, editorial layout, name as oversized typographic element
 - **Oura & Co.** — cream + dark chocolate brown palette, bold sans-serif headlines, asymmetric grid with stats
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Pages to Build

1. Home

2. Services
 3. Portfolio
 4. About
 5. Contact
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Brand Identity

- **Name:** Samuel Meredith — Web Designer
 - **Tagline:** websites that work as hard as you do
 - **Tone:** Relaxed, professional, kind. Like a talented friend who happens to be great at web design.
 - **Audience:** Central Coast tradies, small local businesses, personal brands & creators
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Colour Palette

- **Base:** Warm cream & off-white — #FAF7F2 / #F2EDE6
 - **Primary text:** Deep warm near-black — #1C1814
 - **Dark sections:** Rich chocolate brown — #2C1F14 or #1A1209
 - **Accent:** Warm terracotta — #C4622D
 - **Supporting neutral:** Warm taupe / sand — #C9B99A
 - **Rule:** No cool greys, no blues, no purple. Every tone must have a warm undertone.
 - **Usage:** Cream is the dominant background. Chocolate brown used for hero and CTA sections. Terracotta used sparingly for buttons and highlights only.
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Typography

The Signature Move

Mix **large expressive serif/display + italic + uppercase** in the same headline — this is the defining typographic treatment across all references. Example:

"websites that work" **AS HARD AS YOU DO**

Or:

SAMUEL Meredith — WEB DESIGNER

Font Roles

- **Display / Hero headlines:** A high-contrast editorial serif with personality — options: Cormorant Garamond, Playfair Display, Fraunces, or similar. Must feel elegant and weighty.
- **Body / UI text:** Clean, warm sans-serif — DM Sans, Outfit, or similar. Small, light, refined.
- **Accent / italic moments:** Use the italic weight of the display font for expressive contrast words
- **Avoid:** Inter, Roboto, Arial, Helvetica, Space Grotesk — anything that reads as generic tech

Scale

- Headlines should be **large and unapologetic** — don't scale them down
 - Body text stays small and light — the contrast between massive headlines and fine body copy is intentional
 - "SAMUEL MEREDITH" should appear at least once on the site as an oversized typographic design element (e.g. full-width, spanning a section)
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Layout & Visual Style

- **Density:** Balanced — editorial breathing room, not sparse, not cluttered
 - **Structure:** Asymmetric and grid-breaking — text bleeds to edges, images overlap sections, columns are uneven
 - **Texture:** Flat & clean — no drop shadows, no gradients, no grain overlays
 - **Corner radius:** Slightly rounded — 6px–8px on buttons only. Images and cards: sharp corners.
 - **Dividers:** Thin horizontal rules (1px, warm tone) used between service items. Whitespace used between sections — no decorative dividers.
 - **Photography:** Samuel has professional photos — these should be used as core layout elements, not decorations. Full-bleed, moody, asymmetric placement.
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Hero Section

- **Style:** Dark full-bleed — deep chocolate brown or near-black warm background
- **Layout:** Large overlaid headline text on top of or beside a strong portrait photo
- **Type treatment:** Mix italic serif + uppercase sans in the headline

- **CTA:** Single ghost/outline button in cream
 - **Feel:** Cinematic, confident, immediate — like Images 4 and 6 from references
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Navigation

- **Type:** Sticky — shrinks/compacts as user scrolls
 - **Style:** Clean, minimal — small caps or light weight type, warm cream background once scrolled
 - **Links:** Home · Services · Portfolio · About · Contact
 - **CTA in nav:** "Get in touch" — terracotta or outline style button
 - **Logo:** "Samuel Meredith" left-aligned wordmark, display font
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Services Section / Page

- **Layout:** Horizontal rule list with + expand — NOT cards
 - **Each service:** Service name left-aligned, price right-aligned, thin rule below, + icon to expand description
 - **Style:** Like Celeste Whitmore and Astrid Vít references — clean, editorial, confident
 - **Background:** Cream or off-white
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Animations & Interactions

- **Scroll:** Subtle fade-ins and upward slides as sections enter viewport — understated, professional
 - **Hover on services list:** Rule highlights or text shifts colour on hover
 - **Hover on buttons:** Smooth colour fill or border transition
 - **Hover on portfolio cards:** Slight scale or overlay reveal
 - **No:** Parallax, loading screens, heavy JS animations, anything that slows the page
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Key Typographic Moments (Must Include)

1. **Hero:** Mixed italic/uppercase headline over dark full-bleed background with portrait
2. **Oversized name:** "SAMUEL MEREDITH" as a large typographic design element spanning a full-width section — referencing the Karina and Souvaena treatment
3. **Services:** Line-list layout with + expand, thin rules, no cards

4. **About page:** Large friendly opener — "Hey, *I'm* SAMUEL." mixing italic and uppercase
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Photography Direction

Samuel has professional photos available. Use them as:

- **Hero:** Large portrait, either full-bleed background or asymmetric split layout
 - **About page:** Prominent portrait, ideally asymmetric with text beside/overlapping
 - **Throughout:** Small editorial placements — scattered, cropped unexpectedly, not centred or predictable
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Component Styles

Buttons

- Primary: Terracotta #C4622D, cream text, 6–8px radius
- Ghost/outline: Cream border + cream text (for dark sections)
- Hover: Smooth fill or darken transition

Service List Items

- Full width, thin warm rule below each item
- Name left, price right, + icon far right
- On expand: smooth height transition revealing description

Portfolio Cards

- Sharp corners on images
 - Minimal — image, project type tag (small caps), one-line description
 - Hover: subtle scale 1.02 or warm overlay
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Page-by-Page Notes

Home

- Dark cinematic hero — portrait + mixed-case headline + ghost CTA button
- "Who I Help" — 3 columns, cream background, editorial feel

- Services snapshot — line-list style, 5 items, links to full services page
- Oversized "SAMUEL MEREDITH" typographic band — full width, display font, cream on dark or dark on cream
- About teaser — asymmetric, portrait left, text right
- Final CTA — full-width chocolate brown band, large headline, cream button

Services

- Page header — large display headline + short subheadline
- All 5 services as expandable line-list
- Each expanded item: description paragraph + bullet inclusions
- Custom quote CTA at bottom

Portfolio

- Page header
- 2-column asymmetric grid of project cards
- Each: image, project type (small caps), 1-line description
- Bottom CTA

About

- Large opener: "Hey, *I'm* SAMUEL."
- Asymmetric layout — photo one side, copy other
- "How I work" — 4 values as a clean 2-column or horizontal list
- CTA band at bottom

Contact

- Dark hero band: "Let's talk" — large display type
- Cream section below with clean form
- Fields: Name, Email, Phone (optional), Project type (dropdown), Message, Budget (dropdown)
- Below form: email + location, response time

Footer

- Dark chocolate brown background
- 3 columns: Name + tagline | Services links | Contact email
- Small, light cream type
- Thin warm rule above copyright line

What to Avoid

- Cool grey tones anywhere
- Purple, blue, or any cold accent
- Generic card-based service layouts
- Centred hero layouts (asymmetric preferred)
- Generic fonts (Inter, Roboto, Arial, Space Grotesk)
- Stock photography
- Anything that looks like a typical "web designer portfolio template"
- Shadows or gradients
- Overly decorative elements

The Feel in One Sentence

Warm, editorial, and quietly confident — like a designer who lets the work speak, but knows exactly how to command a room.